Course Schedule

STAT 251 – Fall 2026. Classes begin Monday, August 24 and end Friday, December 11. Labor Day (September 7) and Fall Recess (November 23–27) are university holidays. Final examinations run December 14–18; the STAT 251 final is Monday, December 14, 12:45PM–2:45PM in TLC 040.

Registration and withdrawal deadlines (Fall 2026)

These are the University of Idaho Registrar's official Fall 2026 deadlines. STAT 251 is a **full-term** course, so the *Full term* column is the one that applies to this class; the eight-week columns are included for reference. These deadlines are set by the Registrar, not by the instructor.

University of Idaho Registrar deadlines for Fall 2026, by course length. STAT 251 is a full-term course.

Action	Full term: Aug. 25 – Dec. 19	Early eight-week: Aug. 24 – Oct. 17	Late eight-week: Oct. 20 – Dec. 19
Register, add or wait list *without permission*	September 2, 2026	September 2, 2026	October 24, 2026
Drop (no W)	September 8, 2026	September 2, 2026	October 24, 2026
Change variable credit	September 8, 2026	September 2, 2026	October 24, 2026
Change to pass/fail grading *(submit)*	September 8, 2026	September 2, 2026	October 24, 2026
Audit (AD grade) *(submit)*	September 8, 2026	September 2, 2026	October 24, 2026
Register/add late *with instructor permission override*	September 8, 2026	N/A	N/A
Withdraw to audit (WA grade) *(submit)*	October 31, 2026	September 26, 2026	November 21, 2026

Action	Full term: Aug. 25 – Dec. 19	Early eight-week: Aug. 24 – Oct. 17	Late eight-week: Oct. 20 – Dec. 19
Withdraw *($5 fee charged to account)*	October 31, 2026	September 26, 2026	November 21, 2026

If you need an instructor permission override to add the course late, contact me **before** the September 8 deadline – overrides cannot be issued after that date.

For the authoritative and most current list of deadlines, holidays and the official academic calendar, see the University of Idaho Dates and Deadlines (https://www.uidaho.edu/registrar/dates-deadlines) page and the Academic Calendar (https://catalog.uidaho.edu/calendar/).

Weekly schedule

Please note: this schedule is meant to provide an outline of the semester and is tentative. The pace of the course may deviate from the exact schedule outlined below. Any changes will be announced in class and posted here.

Week-by-week topic schedule for Fall 2026. Tentative; changes are announced in class and posted here.

Day	Date	Topic
		WEEK 1
Monday	August 24, 2026	Syllabus day: policies, website tour, Q&A
Wednesday	August 26, 2026	Introduction: The big picture
Friday	August 28, 2026	Describing and visualizing distributions
		WEEK 2

Day	Date	Topic
Monday	August 31, 2026	Distributions and frequency tables
Wednesday	September 2, 2026	Shape of a distribution; dot plots, stem-and-leaf plots, histograms – **Last day to register, add or wait list without permission**
Friday	September 4, 2026	Measures of location and position
	WEEK 3	
Monday	September 7, 2026	Labor Day - NO CLASS
Wednesday	September 9, 2026	Measures of spread, boxplot – **September 8 was the last day to drop without a W, change variable credit or grading basis, or add with an instructor permission override**
Friday	September 11, 2026	Cumulative distributions; last day of material for Exam 1 – **Homework 1 due Sunday at 11:59PM**
	WEEK 4	
Monday	September 14, 2026	Sampling designs: simple random, stratified, and cluster sampling
Wednesday	September 16, 2026	Exam 1 Review
Friday	September 18, 2026	Exam 1
	WEEK 5	
Monday	September 21, 2026	Sampling designs continued: systematic, stratified, and cluster sampling; sampling and nonsampling error

Day	Date	Topic
Wednesday	September 23, 2026	Course project discussion; basics of experimental design, association vs. causation – **Course project Steps 1–4 can be started**
Friday	September 25, 2026	Experimental design concluded: the three designs, randomization and research ethics; introduction to the normal distribution
		WEEK 6
Monday	September 28, 2026	The normal distribution: density curves, the standard normal, z-scores, the empirical rule
Wednesday	September 30, 2026	The normal distribution continued: identifying outliers, normal quantiles, transformations; sampling distributions, margin of error
Friday	October 2, 2026	Statistical significance; introduction to probability and its rules
		WEEK 7
Monday	October 5, 2026	Probability continued: independence, random variables and discrete probability distributions
Wednesday	October 7, 2026	Discrete distributions continued: expected value, Bernoulli and binomial distributions
Friday	October 9, 2026	Binomial examples and the Poisson distribution; the normal as a continuous distribution – **Homework 2 due Sunday at 11:59PM**
		WEEK 8
Monday	October 12, 2026	Sampling distributions and the standard error
Wednesday	October 14, 2026	Exam 2 Review

Day	Date	Topic
Friday	October 16, 2026	Exam 2 (take-home, open-note, in Canvas) – **due Sunday, October 18 at 11:59PM**
		WEEK 9
Monday	October 19, 2026	Finding normal probabilities; the central limit theorem; confidence intervals for a population mean and a population proportion
Wednesday	October 21, 2026	Confidence intervals continued: confidence levels other than 95%
Friday	October 23, 2026	Intervals for a mean when σ is unknown (the t distribution) – **Course project check (project_check.html) due Sunday, October 25 at 11:59PM**
		WEEK 10
Monday	October 26, 2026	Intervals for a mean when σ is unknown, concluded; choosing a minimum sample size; introduction to significance tests
Wednesday	October 28, 2026	Significance tests: hypotheses, test statistics and P-values
Friday	October 30, 2026	Making a decision; tests for a population proportion and a population mean – **October 31 is the last day to withdraw (W) or withdraw to audit (WA)**
		WEEK 11
Monday	November 2, 2026	Tests for a mean (sigma known vs unknown), composite hypotheses
Wednesday	November 4, 2026	Types of errors in hypothesis tests, statistical power, relationship between confidence intervals and hypothesis tests, parametric vs non-parametric tests: the sign test

Day	Date	Topic
Friday	November 6, 2026	Introduction to two-sample tests, independent vs dependent samples – **Homework 3 due Sunday, November 8 at 11:59PM**
		WEEK 12
Monday	November 9, 2026	Tests for comparing two independent proportions or two independent means
Wednesday	November 11, 2026	Tests for dependent samples, causal inference
Friday	November 13, 2026	Introduction to analyzing categorical variables
		WEEK 13
Monday	November 16, 2026	Goodness-of-fit tests and tests of independence
Wednesday	November 18, 2026	Cramer's V, McNemar's Test, Fisher's exact test
Friday	November 20, 2026	Exam 3 Review – Exam 3 (take-home, open-note, in Canvas) opens – **Homework 4 due Sunday, November 22 at 11:59PM**; **Exam 3 due Sunday, November 29 at 11:59PM**
		WEEK 14 – FALL RECESS
Monday	November 23, 2026	FALL RECESS - No Class
Wednesday	November 25, 2026	FALL RECESS - No Class
Friday	November 27, 2026	FALL RECESS - No Class
		WEEK 15

Day	Date	Topic
Monday	November 30, 2026	Measures of association
Wednesday	December 2, 2026	Correlation and simple linear regression
Friday	December 4, 2026	Coefficient of determination, tests for slope coefficients – **Homework 5 due Sunday at 11:59PM**
	WEEK 16	
Monday	December 7, 2026	Simple linear regression continued: omnibus F-test, checking assumptions
Wednesday	December 9, 2026	Analysis of variance (ANOVA): comparing several means
Friday	December 11, 2026	Final exam Jeopardy review
	FINALS WEEK	
Monday	December 14, 2026	Final Exam, 12:45PM–2:45PM, TLC 040
Saturday	December 19, 2026	Course project due at 11:59PM